

10K Tabs Digital Detox Guide — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

PREPARE TO CLEAR TABS

- ☐ **Export all open tabs to a bookmark folder named with today's date before you start clearing, so nothing is lost during the cleanup process and the fear of losing information doesn't stop you.:** Export all open tabs to a bookmark folder named with today's date before you start clearing, so nothing is lost during the cleanup process and the fear of losing information doesn't stop you.
- ☐ **Install a tab counter extension to determine your exact tab count, since most people discover they have ten times more tabs than they originally estimated.:** Install a tab counter extension to determine your exact tab count, since most people discover they have ten times more tabs than they originally estimated.
- ☐ **Open 10 random tabs from your bookmark archive and categorize each one by asking whether it is current research, a reference you will use this week, a forgotten saved item, or a duplicate of another tab.:** Open 10 random tabs from your bookmark archive and categorize each one by asking whether it is current research, a reference you will use this week, a forgotten saved item, or a duplicate of another tab.
- ☐ **Write down your total tab count so you can measure progress and stay motivated throughout the entire cleanup process, which typically takes several weeks.:** Write down your total tab count so you can measure progress and stay motivated throughout the entire cleanup process, which typically takes several weeks.

PROCESS IN BATCH SESSIONS

- ☐ **Set a 25-minute timer for each tab-clearing session and commit to stopping completely when the timer ends, regardless of how many tabs remain unprocessed.:** Set a 25-minute timer for each tab-clearing session and commit to stopping completely when the timer ends, regardless of how many tabs remain unprocessed.
 - ☐ **Open only 10 tabs from your archive at a time and make a definitive decision on each one by choosing to read it now, bookmark it properly in a specific folder, or close it immediately.:** Open only 10 tabs from your archive at a time and make a definitive decision on each one by choosing to read it now, bookmark it properly in a specific folder, or close it immediately.
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- **Create specific bookmark folders for each topic rather than using generic labels like miscellaneous or read later, because specific organization makes tabs easier to locate later.:** Create specific bookmark folders for each topic rather than using generic labels like miscellaneous or read later, because specific organization makes tabs easier to locate later.
- **Close any tab you cannot honestly commit to reading within the next 7 days, since saved-but-forgotten tabs are exactly what created this problem in the first place.:** Close any tab you cannot honestly commit to reading within the next 7 days, since saved-but-forgotten tabs are exactly what created this problem in the first place.

MAINTAIN TAB DISCIPLINE

- **Set a personal rule to never end the day with more than 20 open tabs and enforce this limit by closing existing tabs before opening any new ones.:** Set a personal rule to never end the day with more than 20 open tabs and enforce this limit by closing existing tabs before opening any new ones.
- **Apply the one-in-one-out rule by closing an existing tab for every new tab you open, which keeps your total tab count stable without feeling overly restrictive.:** Apply the one-in-one-out rule by closing an existing tab for every new tab you open, which keeps your total tab count stable without feeling overly restrictive.
- **Perform a 10-minute weekly review every Friday afternoon to close tabs you have not touched in 7 days, consolidate duplicate tabs, and move research tabs into bookmark folders.:** Perform a 10-minute weekly review every Friday afternoon to close tabs you have not touched in 7 days, consolidate duplicate tabs, and move research tabs into bookmark folders.
- **Track your daily tab count until it consistently stays below 50, which typically takes about three weeks of consistent practice to establish as a permanent habit.:** Track your daily tab count until it consistently stays below 50, which typically takes about three weeks of consistent practice to establish as a permanent habit.